

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Ten • Relationships & Connections

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what relationship did you identify, and what will you do about it?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of building and navigating relationships?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

As with every stage, these are meant to be read aloud and picked selectively. Given this stage's personal nature, be especially attentive to consent — an open prompt about a friendship or team conflict should never be treated as an implicit demand that someone share specifics they'd rather keep private.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Friendships & Peer Connections

"Has a friendship ever surprised you by deepening after a disagreement, rather than being damaged by it?"

"What's a form of support you wish you asked for more often, but don't?"

"Think of the last time someone thanked you specifically and genuinely for something you did — how did that land compared to a generic thank-you?"

"Has anyone ever introduced you to someone in a way that genuinely worked? What made that introduction different from a vague one?"

SESSION 2

Project Partners & Teamwork

"Have you ever assumed a team was aligned on a goal, only to discover partway through that you weren't? What happened?"

"What's the difference between a team that gives feedback constantly versus one that only gives it at the very end? Which have you experienced?"

"Has an unaddressed team conflict ever gotten worse specifically because no one addressed it? What would you do differently now?"

"What's held you back from taking a leadership role in a group, if anything has?"

SESSION 3

Mentorship & Professional Connections

"Has anyone ever mentored you informally, without either of you using that word for it?"

"What's the most useful question you've ever asked a mentor or more experienced person, and what made it useful?"

"Have you ever let a promising professional connection fade simply because you didn't follow up? What would you do differently now?"

"Looking back across this whole stage, which relationship-building area feels most natural to you, and which feels like real, ongoing work?"